

Infinity Fitness Studios

Finding What Was Really Driving Member Retention and Studio Performance

Project Overview

Infinity Fitness Studios wanted a clearer picture of how its studios were performing.

The business had membership and operational data, but getting useful answers from it was taking too much manual effort. More importantly, looking at overall membership numbers did not explain what was happening underneath them.

The questions were more practical:

Why were some members leaving?

Which membership groups were more likely to stay?

Were all studio resources being used effectively?

Were there patterns in member behaviour that could help the business act earlier?

I worked with Infinity Fitness Studios on a paid data analytics engagement from December 2025 to February 2026. My role was to work through the available data, identify the measures that actually mattered to the business, investigate retention and utilization patterns, and turn the findings into something the team could use regularly.

I used SQL, Python and Power BI for the analysis and reporting.

The Business Problem

At first glance, fitness businesses can look straightforward: acquire members, sell memberships and track revenue.

But membership count alone can be misleading.

A studio can continue adding new members while losing existing ones at an unhealthy rate. Some membership plans may appear successful because they have high enrollment but perform poorly on retention. A studio can also have good overall utilization while certain periods or resources remain consistently underused.

That meant I needed to look beyond headline numbers.

I broke the problem into three main questions:

Who is leaving, and are there patterns behind it?

How are different membership groups performing?

How effectively is studio capacity being used?

Those questions became the basis of the analysis.

My Role

I handled the analytical work from understanding the business questions through to presenting the findings.

My responsibilities included:

- understanding the available membership and operational data;
- cleaning and validating the data before analysis;
- defining the KPIs required to measure performance;
- writing SQL queries for analysis and validation;
- using Python for deeper exploration and segmentation;
- analyzing member retention and churn patterns;
- comparing membership segments;
- examining studio utilization;
- performing root-cause analysis where performance differed;
- building the Power BI reporting layer;
- translating the findings into practical business recommendations.

I eventually worked with **25+ KPIs**, but I did not start the project by deciding that the business needed 25 metrics.

The KPIs came from the questions we were trying to answer.

That distinction mattered.

Starting With Retention

One of the first areas I investigated was member retention.

Simply knowing how many memberships had ended would not tell us much. I wanted to understand whether churn was concentrated in particular types of members, plans or behavioural patterns.

So instead of treating all members as one population, I started breaking them into meaningful groups.

I looked at membership characteristics, engagement patterns and other available indicators to understand whether certain groups behaved differently from others.

This made the analysis much more useful.

Rather than saying:

“Member churn is X%.”

the discussion could move toward:

“Which members are contributing most to that churn, and what is different about them?”

That is a much more actionable business question.

Membership Segmentation

The next step was comparing membership groups.

Different plans can attract very different customers.

A plan with a large number of members is not automatically the strongest plan if those members leave quickly. Similarly, a smaller membership category may be commercially valuable if members remain active for longer.

I therefore looked at membership performance from more than one angle.

The analysis considered factors such as:

- member volume;
- retention;
- churn;
- engagement;
- membership behaviour;
- utilization;
- performance differences between segments.

This helped separate **popular membership options** from **healthy membership behaviour**.

That distinction was important because acquisition and retention tell different stories.

Looking at Studio Utilization

Retention was only one side of the project.

I also analyzed how effectively the studio's available capacity was being used.

Overall utilization percentages can hide a lot of variation.

For example, a studio may look busy when viewed at a monthly level while still having periods of significant underutilization.

That matters because unused capacity has a business cost.

I therefore looked for patterns in usage rather than relying only on averages.

The objective was to identify where demand was strong, where capacity was being underused, and where operational decisions could potentially be adjusted.

This allowed utilization to become an operational question rather than simply another dashboard metric.

Root-Cause Analysis

One of the more valuable parts of the engagement was moving from **what happened** to **why it might be happening**.

Whenever I found an unusual result, I tried to break it down further.

If retention differed between groups, I compared the characteristics of those groups.

If utilization appeared weak, I looked at where that weakness was concentrated.

If one membership segment behaved differently, I examined the underlying member behaviour rather than stopping at the aggregate number.

The process was essentially:

Observation → Breakdown → Comparison → Possible Driver → Business Action

This kept the analysis focused on decisions.

A chart showing that something is going wrong is useful.

Knowing where to investigate and what the business can potentially change is much more useful.

Building the KPI Framework

As the analysis developed, I created a set of **25+ KPIs** covering the main areas of studio performance.

The purpose was not to maximize the number of metrics on the dashboard.

Each KPI needed to help answer a business question.

The measures were organized around areas such as:

Membership Performance

How is the member base changing?

Retention & Churn

Are members staying, and where are we losing them?

Member Segmentation

Which groups behave differently?

Utilization

How effectively are studio resources being used?

Operational Performance

Where are there patterns that require management attention?

This made the dashboard easier to use because related metrics told a story together instead of appearing as isolated numbers.

Power BI Dashboard

Once the analysis was stable, I used Power BI to bring the main findings and KPIs into a reporting structure that could be reviewed without repeating the entire analysis manually.

The dashboard was designed in layers.

The first level answered:

“How are we doing?”

The next level helped answer:

“Where is the problem?”

And the detailed analysis helped answer:

“What appears to be driving it?”

That hierarchy was intentional.

Management should not need to inspect every record to understand performance, but they should still be able to move from a high-level KPI into the underlying issue when something requires attention.

Reducing Manual Review

Before the analytical workflow was streamlined, reviewing the data and preparing the required analysis took approximately **six hours**.

By organizing the calculations, queries and reporting process more effectively, I reduced that manual review effort to approximately **2.5 hours**.

That was an important outcome because the value of the project was not limited to the findings from one analysis.

The reporting process itself became more efficient.

Instead of repeatedly spending time assembling and reviewing information, more time could be spent understanding what the numbers meant and deciding what to do about them.

Recommendations

The analysis led to recommendations around two major areas.

Retention

Rather than treating every member who might leave in the same way, retention efforts could be focused on the segments showing stronger signs of churn or weaker engagement.

This creates a more targeted approach than broad retention campaigns.

Operations

Utilization patterns could be used to identify periods or areas where available capacity was not being used effectively.

Those patterns could support decisions around scheduling, promotions, staffing and other operational adjustments.

The recommendations were deliberately tied to findings from the data rather than being generic suggestions for running a fitness business.

What I Would Do Next

If I were extending this work, I would focus on making the analysis more predictive and more closely connected to business actions.

The next stage could include an early-warning approach for member churn.

Instead of identifying churn after a membership has already ended, behavioural indicators could be monitored to flag members whose engagement is declining.

I would also connect retention analysis more closely with customer value.

Not every churn event has the same commercial impact. Combining churn risk with member value would help the business decide where retention efforts are likely to matter most.

Finally, I would measure the outcome of the recommendations themselves.

If a retention action is introduced for a particular segment, the next question should be:

Did it actually improve retention?

That would turn the analysis into an ongoing measurement cycle rather than a one-time project.

Business Impact

The engagement produced three main outcomes.

Better visibility

The business had a clearer view of retention, membership behaviour and utilization through a structured set of 25+ KPIs.

More focused analysis

Instead of relying on overall numbers, performance could be examined by relevant member and operational segments.

Less manual effort

The reporting and review process was reduced from approximately **6 hours to 2.5 hours**, allowing more time to be spent on analysis and decision-making.

Tools Used

SQL

Data extraction, validation, aggregation and KPI calculations.

Python

Data preparation, exploratory analysis, segmentation and deeper investigation of patterns.

Power BI

KPI reporting, interactive analysis and management-level visualization.

Excel

Supporting validation and business review where required.

What This Project Demonstrates

This project was not mainly about building a Power BI dashboard.

The more important work was deciding what to investigate.

The business already had data. My job was to turn that data into answers to practical questions around retention and studio performance.

That required me to move between business analysis and data analysis throughout the engagement:

What is the business trying to understand?

What data can answer that question?

What does the analysis show?

What is causing the result?

What can the business realistically do with that information?

That is the part of the Infinity Fitness Studios engagement I consider most valuable.

The final dashboard made the results easier to consume, but the real work was turning member and operational data into decisions the business could act on.

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